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SSC CGL / CHSL / GD / MTS

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Bilingual Hindi + English

Sindhu-Saraswati Civilization (Indus Valley Civilization)

सिंधु-सरस्वती सभ्यता

India's first urban civilization • World's largest Bronze Age culture • 12.5 lakh sq km • First cotton producers • Most planned cities of ancient world. Complete SSC-oriented bilingual notes with latest July 2026 discoveries.

2600-1900 BCE

Mature Phase

12.5 Lakh km²

Total Area

1500+ Sites

Discovered

1:2:4 Ratio

Brick Standard

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बहुविकल्पीय प्रश्न

✂ **SSC TRICK**

Remember: Sindhu-Saraswati = NCERT New Name. John Marshall gave term Indus Valley in 1924. Always tick Rakhigarhi for Largest Indian site.

01

Nomenclature — Why Three Names?

MOST ASKED IN SSC

John Marshall, 1924

Indus Valley Civilization

First identified along Indus River. Term coined after Mohenjo-daro excavation. Still used internationally.

Daya Ram Sahni, 1921

Harappan Civilization

First site Harappa excavated. Archaeologically correct as per convention — first site name. Type-site Harappa.

ISRO + NCERT, 2023-26

Sindhu-Saraswati

80% sites (1100+) lie on Ghaggar-Hakra/Saraswati, not Indus. Satellite images prove paleochannels. Now NCERT prefers this name.

This civilization is called Indus Valley because John Marshall in 1924 named it after the Indus River where Mohenjo-daro was found. It is called Harappan because Harappa was the first site excavated in 1921 by Daya Ram Sahni. Modern research shows 80% of sites lie

on the dried Ghaggar-Hakra river identified as Vedic Saraswati by ISRO satellite imagery and CSIR-NGRI drilling. Hence NCERT now officially prefers the term **Sindhu-Saraswati Civilization** — very important for SSC 2025-26 papers.

इस सभ्यता को सिंधु घाटी सभ्यता इसलिए कहा गया क्योंकि जॉन मार्शल ने 1924 में सिंधु नदी के किनारे मिले मोहनजोदड़ो के आधार पर यह नाम दिया। हड़प्पा पहला उत्खनित स्थल था (1921, दयाराम साहनी), इसलिए पुरातात्विक परंपरा के अनुसार इसे हड़प्पा सभ्यता भी कहते हैं। आधुनिक शोध में ISRO के सैटेलाइट और CSIR-NGRI की ड्रिलिंग से पता चला है कि 80% स्थल घग्गर-हाकरा (सरस्वती) नदी पर हैं, इसलिए NCERT अब सिंधु-सरस्वती सभ्यता नाम को प्राथमिकता देता है — SSC के लिए अत्यंत महत्वपूर्ण है।

02 Chronology — 4 Phases Timeline

Pre-Harappan Oldest

Bhirrana Phase

7500–6000 BCE

Oldest pottery, pit dwellings. Proves origin in Haryana, not Mesopotamia.

Formative

Early Harappan

3300–2600 BCE

Agriculture, small villages, early trade, Kot Diji, Amri.

Urban Peak • SSC Focus

Mature Harappan

2600–1900 BCE

Grid cities, drainage, seals, script, Great Bath, Dockyard. 700 years golden age.

Decline & Migration

Late Harappan

1900–1300 BCE

Drought, Saraswati drying, de-urbanization, move to Ganga-Yamuna.

Radio-carbon (C14) dating gave 2500-1750 BCE earlier, but new OSL (Optically Stimulated Luminescence) and advanced C14 from Bhirrana push origins to **7500 BCE**, making it older than Egypt & Mesopotamia. Bhirrana is now considered the oldest Harappan site, located on Saraswati paleochannel in Fatehabad, Haryana, excavated by L.S. Rao.

पहले रेडियो-कार्बन डेटिंग से 2500-1750 ईसा पूर्व माना जाता था, पर भिरड़ाना से OSL डेटिंग ने इसे 7500 ईसा पूर्व तक पुराना सिद्ध किया है, जो मिस्र-मेसोपोटामिया से भी प्राचीन है।



SSC Trick: Remember 3-26-19-13

3300 Early, 2600 Mature start, 1900 Late start, 1300 End. Mature = 700 years.

03

Geographical Extent — Largest Ancient Civilization

Covered **12.5 lakh sq km** — bigger than Egypt + Mesopotamia combined. Stretched from Himalayas to Arabian Sea, Indus to Ganga-Yamuna. Two river systems: Indus (Sindhu) in west and Ghaggar-Hakra (Saraswati) in east where 80% sites concentrated. Four boundaries fixed for SSC.

12.5 लाख वर्ग किमी में फैली — मिस्र + मेसोपोटामिया से भी बड़ी। हिमालय से अरब सागर तक, सिंधु से गंगा-यमुना तक। दो नदी तंत्र: पश्चिम में सिंधु और पूर्व में घग्गर-हाकरा (सरस्वती) जहाँ 80% स्थल मिलते हैं।



NORTH Manda

Jammu, Chenab River



SOUTH Daimabad

Maharashtra, Pravara River



EAST Alamgirpur

UP, Hindon River (Meerut)



WEST Sutkagendor

Balochistan, Dasht River

JULY 2026 BREAKING

CSIR-NGRI DISCOVERY

Helicopter EM Survey — 200km Buried Paleochannel Found: Kanpur to Prayagraj

CSIR-NGRI Hyderabad used helicopter-borne electromagnetic mapping and discovered a 200km long, 4-5km wide, 15m deep buried sand-gravel paleochannel from Kanpur to Prayagraj. Massive aquifer — huge groundwater potential. Sediment OSL dates match Vedic

Saraswati flow (Late Pleistocene). Proves Saraswati was not myth but a mighty river system supporting Harappan settlements eastward. Paper in Journal of Earth System Science, May 2026.

CSIR-NGRI ने हेलीकॉप्टर इलेक्ट्रोमैग्नेटिक सर्वे से कानपुर से प्रयागराज तक 200 किमी लंबी दबी हुई प्राचीन नदी (पैलियोचैनल) खोजी – 4-5 किमी चौड़ी, 15 मीटर गहरी रेत-बजरी की जलभृता यह वैदिक सरस्वती के अस्तित्व का वैज्ञानिक प्रमाण है।

04 Discovery History – Who Dug What?

Year	Site	Excavator	River / Detail
1921	Harappa	Daya Ram Sahni	Ravi River, Sahiwal, Pakistan — First excavated
1922	Mohenjo-daro	R. D. Banerjee	Indus, Larkana, Sindh — Mound of Dead
1924	Term “Indus Valley”	Sir John Marshall	DG ASI, announced to world
1953	Kalibangan	Amalananda Ghosh	Ghaggar, Rajasthan — Fire altars
1954	Lothal	S. R. Rao	Bhogava, Gujarat — Dockyard
2011-16	Rakhigarhi	Vasant Shinde	Ghaggar, Haryana — Largest Indian site 550 ha, DNA breakthrough

1921 में हड़प्पा (दयाराम साहनी), 1922 में मोहनजोदड़ो (आर. डी. बनर्जी), 1924 में जॉन मार्शल ने दुनिया को बताया। 1953 कालीबंगा, 1954 लोथल, 2011 राखीगढ़ी – भारत का सबसे बड़ा स्थल।

05 Town Planning – The Hallmark of Civilization

GRID PATTERN + DRAINAGE + BURNT BRICKS = SSC GOLD



Grid Pattern

Roads cut at 90° — chessboard pattern. Main roads 9m wide, lanes 3m. First in world. Houses: courtyard + bathroom + private well. No windows on road side — privacy.



Burnt Bricks 1:2:4

Standard ratio length:width:height = 4:2:1. Only civilization to use burnt bricks on large scale. Mud-brick platform 6-9m high for citadel to save from floods.



World's First Drainage

Covered underground drains with manholes, soak pits, 700 wells in Mohenjo-daro alone. Every house connected. No other ancient civ had this.



Great Bath

12×7×2.4m, gypsum waterproofing, surrounding rooms, ritual bathing — Great Bath of Mohenjo-daro. Earliest public water tank.



Granary

6 granaries in 2 rows, ventilated, near citadel. Largest at Harappa & Mohenjo-daro. State storage system.



Dockyard Lothal

219×37m tidal dockyard, inlet channel, world's earliest dockyard, proved maritime trade with Mesopotamia.

Exceptions: Chanhudaro — only site with **no citadel**, single mound, bead factory town. Dholavira — **3 divisions** (citadel + middle town + lower town), not 2. Rakhigarhi & Harappa also have no clear citadel division now after new digs.

नगर नियोजन विश्व में सबसे उन्नत — ग्रिड पैटर्न, पकी ईंटें 1:2:4 अनुपात, भूमिगत ढकी नालियां, विशाल स्नानागार 12×7×2.4 मीटर, अन्नागार, लोथल गोदीबाड़ा 219×37 मी — विश्व का प्राचीनतम बंदरगाह। चन्हूदड़ो में दुर्ग नहीं, धोलावीरा में 3 भाग।

Site	State / Country	River	Key Finding — SSC Hotspot
Harappa	Punjab, Pakistan	Ravi	First excavated, 6 Granary platforms, Cemetery H &
Mohenjo-daro	Sindh, Pakistan	Indus	Mound of Dead, Great Bath, Granary, 700 wells, Dancing
Dholavira	Gujarat, India	Luni/Man Har	UNESCO WHS 2021 — 40th reservoirs stone-cut, stamped letters, 3 divisions
Rakhigarhi	Haryana, India	Ghaggar (Saraswati)	Largest Indian site 550 ha, no Steppe ancestry, skeletal June 2025 for new aDNA
Lothal	Gujarat	Bhogava	Dockyard 219×37m tidal, Ivory, button seal — earliest
Kalibangan	Rajasthan	Ghaggar	Ploughed field with furrows, fire altars, camel bone, bull
Bhirrana	Haryana	Ghaggar	Oldest 7500 BCE pre-Harappan oldest pottery
Banawali	Haryana	Ghaggar	Oval seal, touchstone, beads, gold, no drainage
Chanhudaro	Sindh, Pak	Indus	Bead & bangle factory, no inkpot, lipstick
Sutkagendor	Balochistan	Dasht	Westernmost boundary, 1000 miles from Babylon (Meluhha), fort
Surkotada	Gujarat	—	Horse bones doubtful (SS fortification)
Alamgirpur	Uttar Pradesh	Hindon	Easternmost boundary, 100 miles from Meerut

12 प्रमुख स्थल – धोलावीरा UNESCO 2021, राखीगढ़ी भारत में सबसे बड़ा 550 हेक्टेयर, लोथल गोदीबाड़ा, कालीबंगा जुता हुआ खेत, भिरड़ाना सबसे प्राचीन 7500 ईसा पूर्व, सुत्कागेंडोर सबसे पश्चिम, आलमगीरपुर सबसे पूर्वी

07 Economy — Agriculture, Crafts & Trade

Crops — First Cotton in World

Wheat, barley, pea, sesame, mustard, cotton — Sindon (Greek name for cotton came from Sindh). Rice found at Lothal & Rangpur. Ploughed field at Kalibangan proves use of wooden plough. Two crops: wheat in winter, rice/millet in monsoon.

Animals

Humped bull (most depicted on seals), buffalo, sheep, goat, elephant, dog, cat, camel at Kalibangan, horse doubtful at Surkotada — SSC trap, not confirmed.

Crafts — Specialized Towns

Bead making: Chanhudaro, Lothal, Dholavira — carnelian, lapis, shell. Shell working: Balakot. Bronze: lost-wax. Seal cutting, weaving cotton. No iron — Bronze Age.

Trade — Meluha = Indus in Mesopotamia

Exports to Mesopotamia: cotton textiles, beads, terracotta, ivory. Imports: Lapis Lazuli from Afghanistan (Shortugai outpost), turquoise from Iran, copper from Rajasthan Khetri. No coins — barter. Weights: cubical chert stone, binary 1-2-4-8-16 and decimal 10-20-100, 160, 320.

अर्थव्यवस्था कृषि प्रधान — गेहूँ, जौ, कपास विश्व में पहली बार यहीं। सिंधु से यूनानी शब्द सिंडोन बना। व्यापार मेसोपोटामिया से, मेलुहा नाम से जाना जाता था। सिक्के नहीं, चर्ट पत्थर के घनाकार बाट, द्विआधारी और दशमलव प्रणाली।

08 Society & Religion — Peaceful Theocracy?

Most Peaceful Civilization

No evidence of weapons, no palaces, no king statues, no monumental wars. Merchant oligarchy or community councils ruled, not a single emperor. 700 years of peace.



Matriarchal & Mother Goddess

Dominance of Mother Goddess figurines (terracotta). Suggests matriarchal. Female deity more common than male.



Pashupati Seal

Proto-Shiva — yogi seated on low throne, surrounded by elephant, tiger, rhino, buffalo, deer. Three-faced, horned. Precursor of Shiva.

Worship: Peepal tree, Swastika symbol (first use), Unicorn (most common animal on seals), Lingam-Yoni, fire altars at Kalibangan & Lothal, water ritual Great Bath.

Burial: Pit burial with pottery, food, ornaments. Fractional burial (bones collected after exposure), urn burial, post-cremation. No mummies. Bodies in north-south direction, face east.

सबसे शांत सभ्यता — हथियार, महल, राजा का कोई साक्ष्य नहीं। मातृदेवी पूजा, पशुपति मुहर पर योगी शिव का आदि रूप, पीपल, स्वस्तिक, एकश्रृंगी पशु, अग्नि पूजा कालीबंगा में, शवाधान गर्त में भोजन-सामग्री के साथ।

09

Art & Craft — Masterpieces



Seals 2000+

Steatite square, animal + script, used as trade marks & amulets. Unicorn 60% seals.



Dancing Girl

Bronze 10.5cm, lost-wax, Mohenjo-daro. Tribhanga posture, bangles, naked. Most famous art.



Priest King

Steatite 17.5cm, bearded, trefoil shawl, half-closed eyes — yogi, Mohenjo-daro.



Mother Goddess

Terracotta, fan-shaped head, prominent breasts — fertility goddess, Harappa.



Pottery



Beads

Red & Black wheel-made, painted with peepal, fish, geometric. Perforated jar for straining.

Etched carnelian, lapis lazuli, shell, gold — Chanhudaro & Lothal factories exported.

कला में मुहरें 2000+, कांसे की नर्तकी 10.5 सेमी मोम-निक्षेप विधि, पुजारी राजा मूर्ति, मातृदेवी मृण्मूर्तियां, लाल-काले मृदभांड, मनके — चन्हूदड़ो मनका कारखाना।

10 Script — The Undeciphered Mystery

Type: Pictographic (like emojis), 400-450 signs

Direction: Right to Left, sometimes Boustrophedon (ox-turning)

Status: Undeciphered — No Rosetta Stone

Avg length: 5 signs

Longest: 26 signs on copper plate

Found on seals, not on paper

Script is pictographic with 400-450 signs, written mostly right to left, sometimes in boustrophedon style where one line goes right-to-left and next left-to-right. It remains undeciphered because no bilingual inscription like Rosetta Stone has been found. Average inscription has only 5 signs, longest has 26 signs. This short length makes decipherment very hard. Scholars debate if it was language or just symbols.

लिपि चित्रात्मक, 400-450 चिन्ह, दायें से बायें, कभी-कभी बोस्ट्रोफेडन। अभी तक अपठित — कोई द्विभाषी अभिलेख नहीं। औसत 5 चिन्ह, सबसे लंबा 26 चिन्ह।

11 Decline Theories — Latest 2025-26 Research

Climate Drought — Nov 2025 Paper **LATEST • IIT Gandhinagar**

Communications Earth & Environment Nov 2025: IIT Gandhinagar + US team paleoclimate reconstruction 3000-1000 BCE shows repeated century-scale droughts, monsoon failure, Ghaggar desiccation forced eastward migration to Ganga-Yamuna. Now most accepted theory.

Saraswati Drying — Tectonic Shift **Geological**

Sutlej & Yamuna shifted course due to tectonic uplift, Saraswati became seasonal then dead. CSIR-NGRI paleochannel evidence supports. Habitations moved east.

Floods at Mohenjo-daro Old Theory

Silt deposits 7 times, Indus floods raised water table, salinity, houses rebuilt on debris. But fails to explain pan-India decline.

Aryan Invasion — REJECTED DNA DISPROVES

Rakhigarhi DNA Cell 2019 (Shinde et al): Harappan genome lacks Steppe pastoralist ancestry. No Central Asian genetic influx. Harappans = Iranian farmers (12k split) + AASI (Ancient Ancestral South Indian). Largest ancestry source for modern South Asians. No massacre evidence.

पतन का मुख्य कारण जलवायु परिवर्तन — 2025 के शोध ने सिद्ध किया 3000-1000 ईसा पूर्व बार-बार सूखा, मानसून विफल, सरस्वती सूखी तो लोग गंगा-यमुना की ओर चले गए। आर्य आक्रमण सिद्धांत राखीगढ़ी DNA से खारिज — मध्य एशियाई वंश नहीं मिला।

12 July 2026 — Latest Updates for SSC

NEW SYLLABUS RELEVANT



Rakhigarhi skeletons to Kolkata — June 2025

2 skeletons sent to AnSI Kolkata for new aDNA with BSIP Lucknow, UCL UK, BHU. To test 2022 claim of no Steppe ancestry with better tech. Report expected Dec 2026.



CSIR-NGRI 200km Paleochannel

Kanpur-Prayagraj 4-5km wide 15m deep sand-gravel aquifer. Helicopter EM. Proof of Vedic Saraswati continuation to Ganga. Groundwater goldmine for UP.



2025 Drought Paper

IIT Gandhinagar paper in Communications Earth & Environment Nov 2025: 3000-1000 BCE repeated droughts led to Ghaggar drying & Harappan migration east.



Dholavira UNESCO 2021

India's 40th World Heritage Site. First Indus site after Mohenjo-daro (1980). Recognized for water conservation — 16 reservoirs rock-cut.



DNA Consensus 2024

Harappans = Iranian Neolithic farmers (12,000 year split) + AASI. No Steppe ancestry till 1500 BCE. Harappans are largest ancestry component for most Indians.



NCERT Renaming Debate

Class 6 new NCERT textbook 2023 uses "Sindhu-Saraswati Civilization" instead of Indus Valley. SSC may now use both names — remember all three names.

13

40 SSC Key Facts — Ratta Maar List

- 1 First site Harappa excavated 1921 Daya Ram Sahni, Ravi river.
- 2 Mohenjo-daro 1922 RD Banerjee, Indus, meaning Mound of Dead.
- 3 Term Indus Valley given by John Marshall 1924.
- 4 Largest site overall Mohenjo-daro, Largest Indian Rakhigarhi 550 ha.
- 5 Smallest site Allahdino near Karachi.
- 6 Northernmost Manda Jammu Chenab, Southernmost Daimabad Maharashtra.
- 7 Easternmost Alamgirpur Hindon UP, Westernmost Sutkagendor Dasht Balochistan.
- 8 Bhirrana oldest 7500-6000 BCE pre-Harappan, Haryana.
- 9 Total area 12.5 lakh sq km, 2 river systems Indus + Ghaggar-Hakra.
- 10 Mature phase 2600-1900 BCE peak, 700 years.
- 11 Grid pattern 90°, burnt bricks 1:2:4, citadel 6-9m high platform.
- 12 Chanhudaro no citadel, Dholavira 3 divisions.

- 13 Drainage covered with manholes, soak pits, 700 wells Mohenjo-daro.
- 14 Great Bath 12×7×2.4m watertight gypsum, ritual.
- 15 Granary 6 in 2 rows, Dockyard Lothal 219×37m earliest dockyard.
- 16 Dholavira UNESCO 2021, 40th WHS, 16 reservoirs, stone fort, signboard.
- 17 Rakhigarhi DNA no Steppe ancestry, Iranian + AASI mix.
- 18 Ploughed field Kalibangan with furrows, fire altars 7.
- 19 Banawali oval seal, touchstone, no drainage.
- 20 Surkotada horse doubtful SSC trap.
- 21 Crops wheat barley pea cotton first Sindon, rice at Lothal.
- 22 Animals humped bull most common on seals, camel Kalibangan.
- 23 Bead factories Chanhudaro Lothal, shell Balakot.
- 24 Trade Meluha to Mesopotamia exports cotton beads, imports Lapis Afghanistan.
- 25 Weights chert cubical binary 1-2-4-8-16 decimal 10-20-100.
- 26 No coins barter, no iron Bronze Age.
- 27 Society peaceful no king weapons, merchant oligarchy.
- 28 Mother Goddess matriarchal, Pashupati Seal proto-Shiva yogi.
- 29 Symbols Peepal Swastika Unicorn most common, fire worship.
- 30 Burial pit with pottery food, fractional & urn, north-south.

- 31 Seals 2000+ steatite square animal script trade mark.
- 32 Dancing Girl bronze 10.5cm lost-wax Mohenjo-daro.
- 33 Priest King steatite bearded trefoil shawl.
- 34 Pottery Red Black wheel painted peepal fish.
- 35 Script pictographic 400-450 signs right to left boustrophedon undeciphered.
- 36 Avg 5 signs longest 26 signs.
- 37 Decline drought 2025 paper + Saraswati drying tectonic Sutlej Yamuna shift.
- 38 Floods Mohenjo-daro silt, Invasion rejected by DNA.
- 39 CSIR-NGRI July 2026 200km paleochannel Kanpur-Prayagraj 4-5km wide 15m deep.
- 40 Rakhigarhi skeletons June 2025 to AnSI Kolkata for new aDNA.

14 MCQs — Final Practice (SSC Pattern)

Q1. Mohenjo-daro is located on which river?

A) Ravi

B) Indus

C) Ghaggar

D) Sutlej

✓ **Answer: B) Indus — Larkana, Sindh, excavated by RD Banerjee 1922**

Ravi = Harappa, Ghaggar = Kalibangan

Q2. Largest Harappan site in India is?

A) Lothal

B) Dholavira

C) Rakhigarhi

D) Kalibangan

✓ **Answer: C) Rakhigarhi — 550 ha, Haryana, Ghaggar river, excavated by Vasant Shinde**
Overall largest = Mohenjo-daro, Indian largest = Rakhigarhi (SSC 2023 asked)

Q3. The famous dockyard was found at?

A) Harappa

B) Lothal

C) Surkotada

D) Banawali

✓ **Answer: B) Lothal — 219*37m tidal dockyard, Bhogava river, earliest dockyard in world**
SR Rao 1954, Gujarat

Q4. Fire altars have been found at?

A) Chanhudaro

B) Kalibangan

C) Alamgirpur

D) Allahdino

✓ **Answer: B) Kalibangan — 7 fire altars + ploughed field, Rajasthan, Ghaggar**
Lothal also has fire altars

Q5. Indus script is?

A) Alphabetic

B) Pictographic

C) Cuneiform

D) Hieroglyphic

✓ **Answer: B) Pictographic — 400-450 signs, right to left, undeciphered, avg 5 signs**
Boustrophedon style also

Q6. Dancing Girl statue is made of?

A) Steatite

B) Bronze

C) Terracotta

D) Iron

✓ **Answer: B) Bronze — 10.5cm, lost-wax technique, Mohenjo-daro, tribhanga posture**

Priest King = steatite

Q7. July 2026 CSIR-NGRI discovery of paleochannel is between?

A) Harappa-Mohenjo-daro

B) Kanpur-Prayagraj

C) Rakhigarhi-Bhirrana

D) Lothal-Dholavira

✓ **Answer: B) Kanpur-Prayagraj — 200km long, 4-5km wide, 15m deep, helicopter EM survey**

Supports Saraswati existence, huge groundwater

Q8. Rakhigarhi DNA study (Cell 2019) proves?

A) Steppe ancestry present

B) No Steppe ancestry, Iranian + AASI

C) Only AASI

D) Only Iranian

✓ **Answer: B) No Steppe ancestry — Iranian Neolithic farmers (12k split) + AASI mix, rejects Aryan invasion**

Harappans largest ancestry source for Indians

Q9. Evidence of ploughed field is found at?

A) Lothal

B) Kalibangan

C) Harappa

D) Dholavira

✓ **Answer: B) Kalibangan — with criss-cross furrows, world's earliest, shows double cropping**

Kalibangan = black bangles also

Q10. Dholavira is famous for?

A) Horse bones

B) Water reservoirs & UNESCO 2021

C) Bead factory only

D) Smallest site

✓ Answer: B) Water reservoirs — 16 stone-cut reservoirs, 3 divisions, stadium, signboard,
UNESCO 40th WHS 2021

Gujarat, Rann of Kutch

Vipulendra Tripathi Sir • SSC History Notes • July 2026

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